

August

30

1983

Space success

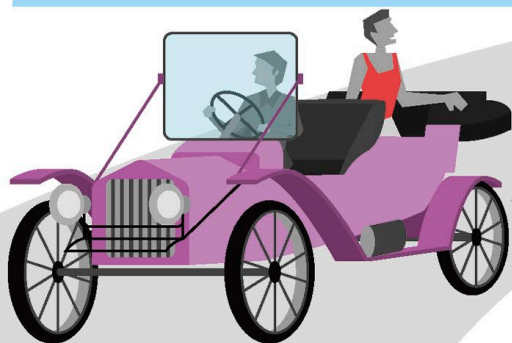
When US Air Force pilot and astronaut Guion S Bluford, Jr launched into orbit aboard Space Shuttle *Challenger*, he became the first Black American to go into space.



Also on this day

1835 The city of Melbourne was founded by European settlers in Australia. This date is now celebrated annually as Melbourne Day.

1941 World War II code breakers at Bletchley Park in the UK, intercepted a message that helped break the cipher used by Germany's Lorenz machine, giving Allied forces access to the Nazis' secret information.



1906

Expert explorer

Norwegian explorer Roald Amundsen became the first person to sail through the Arctic waterway called the Northwest Passage after searching for the route for three years. Five years later, he would lead the first successful expedition to the South Pole.



Born this day

1797 Mary Shelley, British author. She wrote the classic novel *Frankenstein*, which has been adapted into many films and plays.

1972 Cameron Diaz, US actor. She has starred in many comedies and dramas, including *Charlie's Angels*, and voiced the part of Princess Fiona in *Shrek*.



1904

Marathon secret

US runner Fred Lorz crossed the finish line first to win the Olympic marathon in St Louis, USA. Soon after, he admitted cheating by catching a lift in his manager's car for about 18 km (11 miles) of the race, so he was disqualified.